

Don't ask to meet with your boss during the busiest time of the month or busiest days of the week, which for most people are Monday and Friday. It's to your advantage to arrange an appointment at a time that's convenient with your manager.

Consider Benefits in Lieu of Salary

Not all companies are in a position to raise salaries. However, your employer may be able to offer you additional benefits instead, such as extra paid leave, tuition assistance, stock options, overtime, or a promotion, if one is warranted. When comparing salaries, it's important to consider the financial value of these and other benefits and perks. If your company pays for all or part of your health insurance, this is as good as money in your pocket. The same is true of a 401(k) match.



The average employer spends 42 percent of salary costs on employee fringe benefits such as insurance, vacation and other paid leave, retirement contributions, and tuition assistance, including mandatory benefits such as state and federal unemployment insurance and workers' compensation insurance. The average employee making \$40,000 per year receives \$16,800 in benefits.
